Provenance Chain Module (PCHM)

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Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition

Provenance Chain Module (PCHM) defines the structural conditions under which the complete provenance chain of a governed identity remains authentic, continuous, traceable, verifiable, evidence-supported, and continuously governable throughout the complete identity lifecycle.

PCHM governs provenance chains.

The module establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that every governance event, relationship, ownership transition, authority change, and lifecycle milestone remains connected within a continuous and verifiable provenance chain.

A single event has limited meaning.

A connected history creates provenance.

PCHM governs that continuity.

Module Operational Role

PCHM defines the provenance chain layer of PRIS.

Its role is to preserve an uninterrupted governance chain linking every significant lifecycle event associated with a governed identity.

Module Operational Space

PCHM governs:

- provenance chains,
- lifecycle continuity,
- governance chain integrity,
- historical relationships,
- identity lineage,
- governance chronology,
- connected provenance,
- provenance continuity.

Module Function

The module applies wherever organizations must preserve the complete provenance chain of a governed identity across its entire lifecycle.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Provenance Chain Object

Identify the governed identity and the lifecycle events forming its provenance chain.

2. Define Provenance Chain Conditions

Establish governance conditions governing chain continuity, event relationships, traceability, verification, and evidence preservation.

3. Define Provenance Chain Failure Logic

Identify conditions where the provenance chain becomes broken, incomplete, inconsistent, unverifiable, or governance- invalid.

4. Define Governance Response

Define governance actions for chain reconstruction, verification, evidence review, corrective action, or governance escalation.

5. Preserve Provenance Chain Records

Preserve provenance links, governance events, lifecycle relationships, supporting evidence, and historical chain documentation.

Use Case 1 — Enterprise Digital Identity

Scenario

A strategic enterprise identity passes through multiple ownership, authority, and governance changes over many years.

Application

PCHM preserves a continuous provenance chain linking every governance event throughout the identity lifecycle.

Result

The complete governance history remains authentic, reconstructable, and independently verifiable.

Use Case 2 — Cross-Platform AI Identity

Scenario

A governed AI identity operates across multiple platforms while accumulating governance events throughout its operational lifetime.

Application

PCHM maintains a unified provenance chain connecting every governance-relevant lifecycle event.

Result

The identity preserves a continuous, trustworthy, and governance-valid provenance chain across the complete identity lifecycle.

Canonical Closing Statement

Trust is created through continuity, not isolated events. Provenance Chain preserves governance integrity by ensuring that every stage of a governed identity remains permanently connected within one continuous and verifiable lifecycle history.

Related Documents

→ Provenance Integrity Standard (PRIS)

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Canonical Source

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